

Entertainment

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

The entertainment industry has undergone significant changes in the 20th and 21st century, with new technologies and platforms continuously emerging. The invention of cinema in the early 20th century revolutionised the entertainment industry and brought the magic of motion pictures to the masses. The advent of television in the 1950s brought entertainment into the homes of people, providing a new way to watch their favorite shows and movies. A 2020 report states that over 200 million people worldwide subscribe to streaming services and the global gaming market is expected to reach \$196 billion by 2022. The entertainment industry continues to evolve, offering endless options for consumption and making it more accessible and convenient for people. The entertainment industry has also become more interactive and immersive, with virtual reality technology making it possible for people to experience new worlds and new perspectives. The entertainment industry has also become more inclusive with the rise of diverse content, catering to different cultures, communities and interests.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement. Record or write down your questions.

Family weekend on the lake!



You are considering spending time on the lake and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location;
2. accommodation;
3. price for the weekend for a family of three;
4. fishing equipment rental.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

Birthday parties for all ages!



You are considering celebrating your birthday party in this café and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. types of food served;
2. vegetarian dishes;
3. dancing floor;
4. group discounts.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Finding mistakes

Read the following answers given by students. Find mistakes or the reasons why the answers will not be approved.

Interviewer: What are your favourite means of entertainment?

Student: I like dance. I also like watching films with my family.

Interviewer: How often do you watch films? What is your favourite genre?

Student: I watch films every weekend. My favourite genre is science fiction.

Interviewer: Are there any activities that you dislike doing? Why?

Student: I dislike watching ballet because it's so boring to me.

Interviewer: Do you like having your photos taken? Why or why not?

Student: I like taking photos. I think it's really interesting and I can share my photos with my friends.

Interviewer: What sort of places will be interesting for people in the future? Why do you think so?

Student: I believe people will be interested in visiting parks because they'll need fresh air to breathe. The ecology gets worse every year so such places will help.

Now, try to do the task yourself.

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss how modern teenagers have fun. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: What are your favourite means of entertainment?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How often do you watch films? What is your favourite genre?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Are there any activities that you dislike doing? Why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you like having your photos taken? Why or why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What sort of places will be interesting for people in the future? Why do you think so?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss entertainment. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Do modern galleries and museums appeal to young people?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What can make teenagers be more interested in visiting museums and galleries?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How often do you go to parties? What do you do there?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What kinds of music do you listen to? Where do you usually listen to music?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What kinds of activities would you choose to spend time with your family? Do your parents share your interests?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. Where is your place for a family weekend on the lake located?
2. What kind of accommodation do you provide?
3. How much is the weekend for a family of three?
4. Can I rent any fishing equipment at your place?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. What types of food are served in your café?
2. Are there any vegetarian dishes? \ Do you have any vegetarian dishes?
Do you serve vegetarian dishes in your café?
3. Is there a dancing floor in your café? \ Do you have a dancing floor?
4. Do you provide any group discounts? Do you have any group discounts?

Answers for Speaking Part 3. Finding mistakes:

1. There is a basic grammar mistake: like + ing so the answer cannot be approved. You should say 'I like dancing. I also like watching films with my family.'
2. This answer will be approved – two grammatically correct sentences that answer both of the questions.
3. This is one complex sentence. You cannot get a point if there is only one sentence. You should say 'I dislike watching ballet because it's so boring to me. Unfortunately, my parents make me watch one every month.'
4. The question is not about that. It is whether you like when someone takes a picture of you. You should say 'I like having my photos taken. I like how I look in pictures. I think such photos are always better than selfies.'
5. There is a basic grammar mistake in the sentence: The ecology is getting worse every year – it's a developing situation, so you should use the Present Continuous. In addition, the question is not about a healthy choice, it's about a place that might interest people for some reason. Most of the examiners will not approve of such an answer. You should say 'I believe people will be interested in visiting museums that will show how people lived in the 20th and 21st century. In my opinion, it will be interesting to find out what kind of mistakes we've made and what problems could have been avoided.'

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. I believe modern galleries and museums appeal to young people. Schools usually organise excursions for students to visit such places. This makes them get more interested in different types of art.
2. I believe schools should introduce a special class where teenagers will learn about different objects in museums: how they were created, what their influence in history was and so on. This will encourage teenagers to visit museums and galleries to see the objects with their own eyes.
3. I go to parties about once a month. I meet new friends, chat a lot, sometimes I dance at parties.
4. I like listening to modern pop and rock music. I usually listen to music on my way to school or at home in the evening.
5. I like going fishing with my family. We make BBQ together and it's a lot of fun. So, yes, my parents share my interests.

Speaking Part 4. Task 1

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Entertainment with family members". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two ways of spending time;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two ways of spending time;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which way of spending time with family presented in the pictures you preferred as a child and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12–15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Sample answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

Hi Misha, it's Anton. Listen, I've found two good pictures for our project "Entertainment with family members".

I suppose we should use the pictures as they are perfectly suitable. They both show families spending time together. In the first picture I can see a woman and two kids watching TV. They are sitting on the sofa and they are smiling. Perhaps they're watching a comedy. In the second picture, there's a family of four having a picnic in the field. The children are sitting on their parents' lap. There's a noticeable difference between the pictures. It's in the place where the families are having fun. The first family is indoors while the second one is outdoors.

Both of the ways of spending time have their own advantages. You can watch TV at home no matter how good the weather is, it's always warm and comfortable. But you can also enjoy yourselves a lot in nature if the weather is nice. Such type is usually more active and you can play different games with your family.

There are also some downsides of the two ways of spending time. If you watch TV, you do not get to know anything about your nearest and dearest. This activity is also sedentary so you don't develop physically if you only entertain yourself this way. As for spending your time outdoors, it's only possible to do it in good weather and you can get cold in the evening if the weather is not warm enough.

As a child, I preferred to spend time with my family outdoors. We often went for a picnic together. I got really close to my parents when we did that because we shared different stories.

That's all for now. Call me back and tell me whether you approve of the pictures I've found. Bye.

Writing an email. Task 1

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Bob:

From: Bob@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Graduation party
<i>... I've enrolled at a university in Oxford. Their design school is just amazing. What do you plan to do after school? By the way, what's your graduation party going to be like? What are you going to wear? ... My younger sister has started taking tennis lesson...</i>

Write an email to Bob.

In your message:

- answer his questions;
- ask **3 questions** about his younger sister.

Write **100–140 words**.

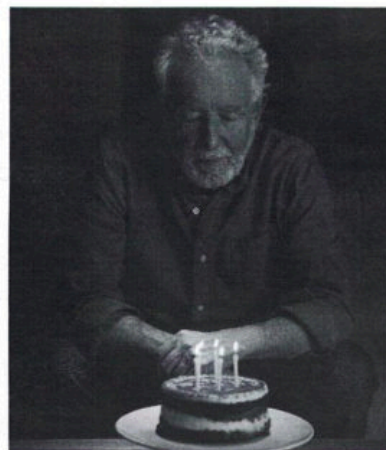
Remember the rules of email writing.

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Birthday parties" together with your friend. You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1–2) of the two types of birthday parties;
- mention the disadvantages (1–2) of the two types of birthday parties;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which kind of birthday party presented in the pictures you prefer and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12–15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Sample answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hello Sofia, it's Sveta. I have some good news. I've found two wonderful pictures for the project we're both doing "Birthday parties". I want to tell you about them.

In my opinion, both of the pictures are perfectly suitable for our project as there are birthday parties depicted in them. In the first photo I can see a group of children around a cake. There is a girl blowing out the candles. The children are smiling. In the second picture there's an old man sitting in front of a cake with candles. He looks really sad. Perhaps no one has come to his party. The difference between the pictures is in the ways the birthday parties are celebrated: with a group of friends or alone.

There are some distinct advantages of the two types of birthday parties. If you celebrate it with friends, you are happy and cheerful and you can share precious moments together. Such parties are usually quite memorable. However, if you are on your own, no one disturbs you and you don't have to pay a huge sum of money to organise such a party.

I can also see some downsides of celebrating both of the types of birthday parties. A party with friends is quite costly and you have to entertain your guests or pay for an animation team. As for celebrating your birthday alone, I believe it's quite boring and sad. People usually experience terrible feelings when there is no one to come or no one even calls you.

Personally, I prefer having a birthday party with my friends. They usually give me nice presents, the ones I really need and we like to reminisce on the occasion afterwards because it's usually a lot of fun.

That's all I wanted to tell you about the pictures and my preferences. Call me back in the evening to discuss the project. Bye.

Suggested answer for Writing an email. Task 1:

Dear Bob,

Thanks for your message. It's always nice when you drop a line.

In your letter you asked me some questions about my graduation party and my plans for the future. My school is preparing a grand graduation party for us. We're going to sail on a ship but before that they'll give us our diplomas and I expect that'll be lots of fun. I'm going to wear a designer dress because it's quite a formal occasion. After school I'm taking some exams at MSU because I want to study there. I'll also go on a trip abroad with my parents.

By the way, tell me about your younger sister. How old is she? What other hobbies does she have? What does she look like?

Hope to hear from you soon.

Love,

Masha

(134 words)

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Sophia:

From: Sophia@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: Summer holidays
<i>...Summer is on the way! I'm really looking forward to going to Greece this summer. Where do Russian teenagers spend their summer holidays? What entertainment is popular among them? How do you prefer to spend your free time?</i>
<i>I've finally passed all my exams...</i>

Write an email to Sophia.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask **3 questions** about her school-leaving exams.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Fill in the gaps with suitable words in the following sample email:

Dear Sophia,

Thanks for your email. I'm always happy to hear _____ you.

I'll _____ answer your questions _____ how teenagers in Russia spend their summer holidays. Well, some of _____ usually stay where they _____ and hang out with friends a lot. _____ go to _____ country houses and spend the summer with their _____. I believe _____ to the cinema is very popular among Russian teenagers. As for me, I prefer playing computer games _____. I have some free time.

It's _____ that you finally took all your exams. Were they hard? How _____ exams did you _____? How long did they _____?

I need to help my mom with cleaning. Write back _____.

All the best,

Lesha

120 words

Answers for Writing an email. Task 2

Dear Sophia,

Thanks for your email. I'm always happy to hear from you.

I'll happily\gladly answer your questions about how teenagers in Russia spend their summer holidays. Well, some of them usually stay where they are and hang out with friends a lot. Others go to their country houses and spend the summer with their grannies. I believe going to the cinema is very popular among Russian teenagers. As for me, I prefer playing computer games whenever\when I have some free time.

It's awesome\great\wonderful that you finally took all your exams. Were they hard? How many exams did you take? How long did they last?

I need to help my mom with cleaning. Write back soon.

All the best,

Lesha

120 words

Writing Task 38. Task 1

Imagine that you are doing a project on **what film genres are popular among teenagers in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.

The survey question: What's your favourite film genre?	
Film genre	Number of respondents (%)
Fantasy, sci-fi	42
Horror, thriller	23
Comedy	18
Drama, melodrama	12
Detective films	5

Write **200–250 words**.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that can arise with watching films and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the importance of watching films in our lives.

First, identify what comparisons you may make using the following phrases:

almost\approximately twice as many\popular	
more than twice as many\popular	
more than three times as many\popular	
almost\approximately five times as many\popular	

Match the following comparisons with the comments:

Interestingly, horror films and thrillers are almost five times as popular among the youth in Zetland (23%) as detective films (5%).	
Surprisingly, almost twice as many of the adolescents watch horrors and thrillers (23%) as those who prefer dramas and melodramas (12%).	
Predictably, more than three times as many of the respondents choose to watch comedies (18%) as detective films (5%).	
Interestingly, fantasy and sci-fi films are more than twice as popular among the teenagers (42%) as comedies (18%).	

- It seems that teenagers in Zetland are more eager to have fun than spending their time figuring out who murdered whom in the film.
- It seems that the teenagers in the country crave for the unknown but real-life events are not that interesting for them.
- This is probably because teenagers want to explore new worlds and dream about discoveries of new planets and how we might inhabit them. Much fewer teenagers in Zetland seem to need fun in their lives.
- I believe this might be because teenagers in Zetland lack strong emotions but it is quite easy for them to build relationships and they know how to do it.

Answers for Writing Task 38. Task 1

Comparisons:

almost\approximately twice as many\popular	horror films, thrillers and dramas, melodramas Fantasy, sci-fi and comedies
more than twice as many\popular	Fantasy, sci-fi and comedy dramas, melodramas and detective films
more than three times as many\popular	Comedy and detective films
almost\approximately five times as many\popular	horror films, thrillers and detective

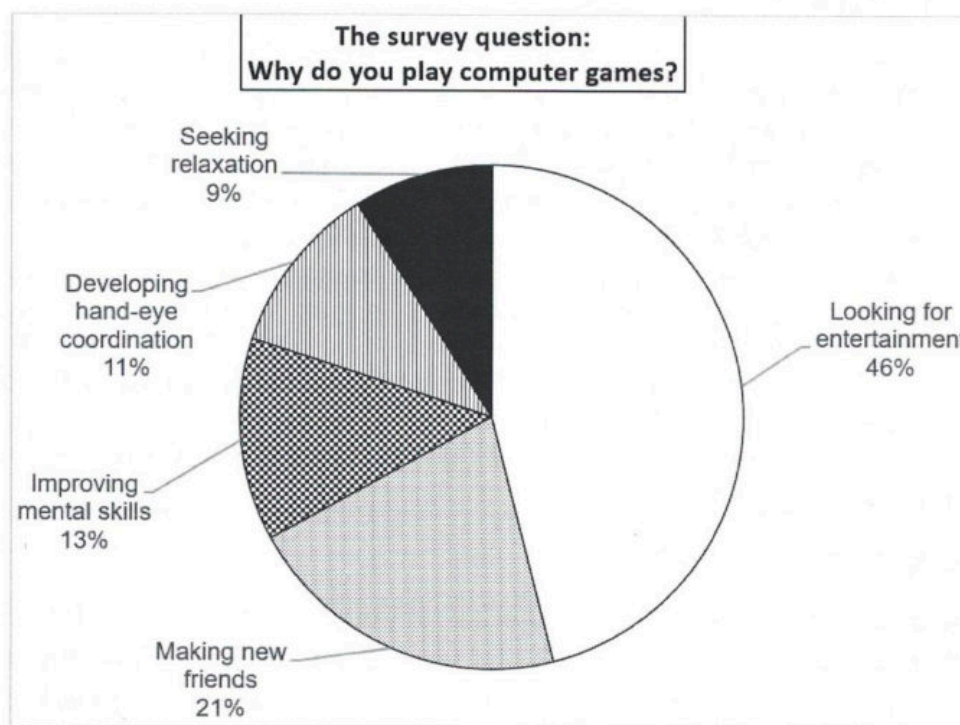
Comments:

Interestingly, horror films and thrillers are almost five times as popular among the youth in Zetland (23%) as detective films (5%).	b) It seems that the teenagers in the country crave for the unknown but real-life events are not that interesting for them.
Surprisingly, almost twice as many of the adolescents watch horrors and thrillers (23%) as those who prefer dramas and melodramas (12%).	d) I believe this might be because teenagers in Zetland lack strong emotions but it is quite easy for them to build relationships and they know how to do it.
Predictably, more than three times as many of the respondents choose to watch comedies (18%) as detective films (5%).	a) It seems that teenagers in Zetland are more eager to have fun than spending their time figuring out who murdered whom in the film.
Interestingly, fantasy and sci-fi films are more than twice as popular among the teenagers (42%) as comedies (18%).	c) This is probably because teenagers want to explore new worlds and dream about discoveries of new planets and how we might inhabit them. Much fewer teenagers in Zetland seem to need fun in their lives.

Writing Task 38. Task 2 (Sample answer on page 176)

Imagine that you are doing a project on **why computer games are popular among teenagers in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write **200–250 words**.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant;
- outline a problem that can arise with playing computer games and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the role of computer games in teenagers' life.